



Ethnography in Business: Uncovering Customer Needs Through Cultural Research

【剑桥雅思11 | 听力真题 Test 3 Section 4 | 揭秘人种志：商业洞察新视角 | 从厨房到非洲手机 | 如何设计客户真正想要的产品】

Summary: Ethnography, a research method rooted in anthropology, is increasingly being used in business to gain deep insights into customer needs and behaviors. Companies employ ethnographic studies to design better products, from kitchen equipment to mobile phones, by observing real-world usage. Researchers emphasize open-mindedness and first-hand observation, allowing participants to guide the study rather than testing predefined hypotheses. The method involves extensive data analysis to identify patterns and meaningful insights, which ultimately inform the design process.

摘要：人种志作为一种源于人类学的研究方法，正被企业广泛运用于挖掘客户需求和行为模式。通过观察真实使用场景，企业成功改进了从厨房量杯到全球手机等功能设计。这种研究强调开放思维和实地观察，让参与者而非研究者主导方向。研究人员需分析海量数据以识别规律，最终将深刻洞察反馈至产品设计流程，典型案例包括为乌干达设计的通话计时功能，以及帮助护士移动查房的平板电脑。



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听9遍
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🕒 Estimated Reading Time: 9 min.

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🎧 Section 4 You will hear part of a lecture to business students about the use of one particular type of research known as ethnography.

第四部分，你将听到一场面向商学院学生的讲座，内容是关于一种特定类型的研究方法——民族志。

🎧 First, you have some time to look at questions 31 to 40.

首先，你有时看下一第31到40题。

▶ Signs Now listen carefully and answer questions 31 to 40.

现在请仔细听并回答第31到40题。

▶ So what I'm going to talk about to you today is something called ethnography.

今天我要和大家讨论的是一种叫做民族志的研究方法。

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▶ This is a type of research aimed at exploring the way human cultures work.

这是一种旨在探索人类文化运作方式的研究。

▶ It was first developed for use in anthropology and it's also been used in sociology and communication studies.

它最初是为人类学开发的，后来也被用于社会学和传播学研究。

▶ So what's it got to do with business you may ask?

你可能会问，这跟商业有什么关系？

▶ Well, businesses are finding that ethnography can offer them deeper insight into the possible needs of customers, either present or future, as well as providing valuable information about their attitudes towards existing products.

企业发现，民族志可以为他们提供对客户当前或未来需求的更深入洞察，同时还能提供关于客户对现有产品态度的宝贵信息。

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▶ And ethnography can also help companies to design new products or services that customers really want.

民族志还能帮助企业设计客户真正需要的新产品或服务。

▶ Let's look at some examples of how ethnographic research works in business.

让我们看一些民族志研究在商业中如何应用的例子。

▶ One team of researchers did a project for a company manufacturing kitchen equipment.

一个研究团队为一家厨房设备制造公司做了一个项目。

▶ They watched how cooks used measuring cups to measure out things like sugar and flour.

他们观察厨师如何使用量杯来测量糖和面粉等食材。

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▶ They saw that the cooks had to check and recheck the contents, because although the measuring cups had numbers inside them, the cooks couldn't see these easily.

他们发现厨师不得不反复检查量杯内容，因为尽管量杯内部有刻度，但厨师很难看清。

▶ So a new design of cup was developed to overcome this problem and it was a top seller.

于是，他们设计了一种新的量杯来解决这个问题，结果这种量杯成为了畅销品。

▶ Another team of ethnographic researchers looked at how cell phones were used in Uganda, in Africa.

另一个民族志研究团队研究了非洲乌干达的手机使用情况。

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▶ They found that people who didn't have their own phones could pay to use the phones of local entrepreneurs.

他们发现没有手机的人可以付费使用当地企业家的手机。

▶ Because these customers paid in advance for their calls, they were eager to know how much time they'd spent on the call so far.

由于这些客户提前支付通话费用，他们迫切想知道已经通话了多久。

▶ So the phone company designed phones for use globally with this added feature.

于是，这家手机公司设计了一款全球通用的手机，并增加了这一功能。

▶ Ethnographic research has also been carried out in computer companies.

民族志研究也在计算机公司中开展过。

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▶ In one company, IT systems administrators were observed for several weeks.

在一家公司中，IT系统管理员被观察了几周。

▶ It was found that a large amount of their work involved communicating with colleagues in order to solve problems, but that they didn't have a standard way of exchanging information from spreadsheets and so on.

研究发现，他们的大部分工作涉及与同事沟通以解决问题，但他们没有标准化的方式来交换电子表格等信息。

▶ So the team came up with an idea for software that would help them to do this.

于是，团队提出了一种软件创意来帮助他们实现这一点。

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▶ In another piece of research, a team observed and talked to nurses working in hospitals.

在另一项研究中，一个团队观察并与医院工作的护士交谈。

▶ This led to the recognition that the nurses needed to access the computer records of their patients no matter where they were.

这让他们意识到，护士需要随时随地访问患者的电子记录。

▶ This led to the development of a portable computer tablet that allowed the nurses to check records in locations throughout the hospital.

于是，他们开发了一种便携式电脑平板，让护士可以在医院各处查看记录。

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▶ Occasionally, research can be done even in environments where the researchers can't be present.

有时，研究甚至可以在研究人员无法亲临的环境中进行。

▶ For example, in one project done for an airline, respondents used their smartphones to record information during airline trips.

例如，在为一家航空公司做的一个项目中，受访者在飞行途中用智能手机记录信息。

▶ In a study aiming at tracking the emotions of passengers during a flight.

这项研究旨在追踪乘客在飞行过程中的情绪。

▶ So what makes studies like these different from ordinary research?

那么，这些研究与普通研究有何不同？

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▶ Let's look at some of the general principles behind ethnographic research in business.

让我们看看商业民族志研究背后的一些基本原则。

▶ First of all, the researcher has to be completely open-minded.

首先，研究人员必须完全保持开放的心态。

▶ He or she hasn't thought up a hypothesis to be tested as is the case in other types of research.

他或她不会像其他类型的研究那样提出待验证的假设。

▶ Instead, they wait for the participants in the research to inform them.

相反，他们会等待研究参与者提供信息。

▶ As far as choosing the participants themselves is concerned, that's not really all that different from ordinary research.

就选择参与者本身而言，这与普通研究并没有太大区别。

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▶ The criteria according to which the participants are chosen may be something as simple as the age bracket they fall into, or the researchers may select them according to their income, or they might try to find a set of people who all use a particular product, for example.

选择参与者的标准可能很简单，比如他们的年龄段，或者研究人员可能根据收入选择，或者他们可能试图找到一组使用特定产品的人。

▶ But it's absolutely crucial to recruit the right people as participants.

但招募合适的参与者至关重要。

▶ As well as the criteria I've mentioned, they have to be comfortable talking about themselves and being watched as they go about their activities.

除了我提到的标准外，他们还必须愿意谈论自己，并在活动过程中接受观察。

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▶ Actually, most researchers say that people open up pretty easily, maybe because they're often in their own home or workplace.

实际上，大多数研究人员表示，人们很容易敞开心扉，可能是因为他们通常在自己的家或工作场所。

▶ So what makes this type of research special is that it's not just a matter of sending a questionnaire to the participants.

因此，这种研究的特别之处在于，它不仅仅是向参与者发送问卷。

▶ Instead, the research is usually based on first-hand observation of what they're doing at the time.

相反，研究通常基于对他们当时行为的第一手观察。

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▶ But that doesn't mean that the researcher never talks to the participants.

但这并不意味着研究人员从不与参与者交谈。

▶ However, unlike in traditional research, in this case, it's the participant, rather than the researchers, who decides what direction the interview will follow.

然而，与传统研究不同，在这种情况下，是参与者而非研究人员决定访谈的方向。

▶ This means that there's less likelihood of the researcher imposing his or her own ideas on the participant.

这意味着研究人员将自己的想法强加给参与者的可能性更低。

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▶ But, after they've said goodbye to their participants and got back to their office, the researchers' work isn't finished.

但是，在与参与者告别并回到办公室后，研究人员的工作并未结束。

▶ Most researchers estimate that 70-80% of their time is spent not on the collecting of data, but on its analysis, looking at photos, listening to recordings and transcribing them and so on.

大多数研究人员估计，他们70-80%的时间不是花在数据收集上，而是花在数据分析上，比如查看照片、听录音并转录等。

▶ The researchers may end up with hundreds of pages of notes, and to determine what's significant they don't focus on the sensational things or the unusual things.

研究人员最终可能会有数百页的笔记，而为了确定哪些内容重要，他们不会关注那些耸人听闻或不寻常的事情。

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▶ Instead, they try to identify a pattern of some sort in all this data, and to discern the meaning behind it.

相反，他们会尝试从所有这些数据中找出某种模式，并辨别其背后的含义。

▶ This can result in some compelling insights that can, in turn, feed back to the whole design process.

这可能会产生一些引人注目的见解，进而反馈到整个设计过程中。

▶ That is the end of section 4.

第四部分到此结束。

▶ You now have half a minute to check your answers.

现在你有半分钟时间检查答案。

▶ That is the end of the listening test.

听力测试到此结束。

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▶ You now have 10 minutes to transfer your answers to the answer sheet.

现在你有10分钟时间将答案誊写到答题卡上。

▶ Please stop writing and wait for your question booklet to be collected.

请停止作答，等待回收试题册。

▶ The answer sheet is the answer sheet.

答题卡就是答题卡。

▶ Please stop writing and wait for your question booklet to be collected.

请停止作答，等待回收试题册。

